DEPARTMENT OF THE ARMY
Mission and Installation Contracting Command Fort Eustis
705 Washington Blvd, Suite 126W, Fort Eustis VA 23604
Request for Proposal (RTOP)
Defense Language Institute Foreign Language Center (DLIFLC)
Academic Network Labor Contract

RFP Title: DLIFLC Academic Network Labor Contract

Issued under GSA 8(a) STARS III

Date of Issue: 12 December 2025

Issuing Office: Mission and Installation Contracting Command (MICC) – Fort Eustis at 705 Washington Blvd, Fort Eustis, VA 23604

Agency Point of Contacts:
Contracting Specialist, Kailah Brinson, kailah.n.brinson.civ@army.mil
Contracting Officer/Division Chief, Andrew Minnix, Andrew.m.minnix.civ@army.mil

RFP Questions Deadline: This RTOP solicitation serves as a continuation of RFP #1770674, which was subsequently closed due to the Government Shutdown from October 1 to November 17. In response to the high volume of questions received during the initial solicitation, offerors are permitted to submit a second round of questions. Each offeror may submit no more than 10 follow-up questions. Not all questions will be answered. In the interest of efficiency, the Contracting Officer shall determine which questions are answered based upon impact and merit. Questions regarding this RTOP shall be submitted **NLT 18 December 2025 at 12:00 PM EST** via email to Ms. Kailah Brinson at kailah.n.brinson.civ@army.mil and Mr. Andrew Minnix at Andrew.m.minnix.civ@army.mil.

RFP Closing Date & Time: 17 February 2026 at 4:00 PM EST

Description of Services: The purpose of this non-personal services contract is to administer, maintain, secure and accredit the DLIFLC Academic Network which provides an IT environment for 100% of the DLIFLC teachings and instructing for all students, faculty and guests in a learning environment at an unclassified level.

1.0 GSA 8(a) STARS III

1.1 NAICS Code and Small Business Standard: The principal nature of the requirements described in this Request for Proposal (RTOP) is consistent with services performed by industries in 541512, Computer Systems Design Services with a size standard of $34 million.

1.2 Product Service Code (PSC): The services in this solicitation are best represented by PSC code: DG01 Information Technology (IT) and Telecom – Network Support Services (Labor).

1.3 Type of Contract: The type of contract resulting from this solicitation is a Firm Fixed Price TO (Task Order) with Not to Exceed Travel contract line items.

1.4 Type of Services: The services being procured are commercial.

1.5 Extent of Competition: This is an 8(a) Set-Aside.

1.6 Performance Location: The primary performance location is CONUS. Services will be performed at Presidio of Monterey, Monterey CA; Mililani, HI; Fort Huachuca, AZ; and Crystal City, VA. Performance can also be located temporarily at Learning Training Detachment (LTD) sites throughout the Continental United States. There may be instances of OCONUS work IAW the Performance Work Statement.

1.7 Period of Performance: The Period of Performance shall consist of an 11-month Base year plus a 30 calendar days phase-in period and four 4 12-month option years.

Table 1. Period of Performance	
Phase In	10 June 2026 – 09 July 2026
Base	10 July 2026 – 09 June 2027
Option Year 1	10 June 2027 – 09 June 2028
Option Year 2	10 June 2028 – 09 June 2029
Option Year 3	10 June 2029 – 09 June 2030
Option Year 4	10 June 2030 – 09 June 2031

Estimated Award Date 01 MARCH 2026

2.0 ADMINISTRATIVE DATA

2.1 Task Order Request for Proposal and Inquiries:
2.1.1 Email Proposals must have the subject line “DLIFLC Academic Network Labor Contract RTOP#1787732” and be received in full by the deadline. Early submission of Proposals is highly encouraged to allow enough time for consideration for award. If the Proposal is not received in full by the closing deadline, the Proposal shall be rejected as late. Due to size restrictions, individual emails cannot exceed 10MB, including attachments. Proposals exceeding this limit must be split into multiple emails clearly and appropriately labeled, each under 10MB. Compressed attachments are prohibited and will be blocked.

2.1.1.1 The Government will accept emailed proposals; however, offerors are encouraged to utilize GSA E-buy’s proposal submission utility to respond to this solicitation. Either method of submission is acceptable. Regardless of the method of transmission it is the offeror’s responsibility to ensure the Government’s receipt of all elements of the proposal.

2.1.2 Period for acceptance of offers. The Offeror agrees to hold the prices in its offer firm 150 days from the Proposal due date.

2.1.3 This is a follow-on procurement to the incumbent contract W91QF4-23-F-0195. All relevant public information regarding the incumbent contract can be found, free of charge, on https://www.usaspending.gov/. The Government will not entertain inquiries seeking additional non-public information regarding the incumbent contract.

2.2 General Instructions:

2.2.1 If an Offeror believes that the requirements in these instructions contain an error, an ambiguity, omission, or are otherwise unclear, the Offeror shall immediately notify the Contracting Officer, in writing with supporting rationale.

2.2.2 In addition to the clauses set forth in the GSA 8(a) STARS3 master contract, Attachment 3 contains provisions and clauses that will be incorporated by reference and by full text in the resulting award.

2.2.3 Offerors shall provide all information requested in the RTOP. A Proposal may be rejected if it fails to meaningfully respond to the instructions specified in this RTOP. Examples of failures may include, but are not limited to the following:

a. The Proposal merely repeats, rephrases or restates the task order PWS requirements without elaboration or fails to present more than a statement indicating its capability to comply with the RTOP terms and does not provide support or detail how they will perform.

b. The Proposal fails to provide data and information required in the RTOP.

c. The Proposal demonstrates a lack of technical competence or failure to address the complexity and risk required to perform the RTOP requirements. When the Proposal is too high in price to be considered reasonable, and/or unachievable in terms of technical, labor mix, or schedule commitments.

d. The Proposal individual line-item prices are significantly inflated or deflated, which often indicates an attempt to offset overpricing with underpricing, as the Proposal will be evaluated for balance. An unbalanced Proposal lacks a clear correlation between the effort required and the proposed price for each base and option year.

e. The Proposal contains major error(s), omission(s) and/or deficiencies that indicate a lack of understanding or an approach that cannot be expected to meet requirements or involves a very high risk and none of these conditions can be corrected without major rewrites or revisions of the Proposal.

f. The Proposal offers a product or service that does not meet all stated requirements of the RTOP.

g. The Proposal includes citations for, or links to websites.

2.2.4 Offerors are required to make a preliminary disclosure to the Contracting Officer, prior to the due date for receipt of Proposals, of any Organizational Conflicts of Interest issues the Offeror has identified.

3.0 CONTRACT LINE ITEMS (CLINs) and CONTRACT TYPE BY CLIN

3.1 Attachment 2 contains applicable CLIN and Contract Type by CLIN information for this RTOP.

4.0 DESCRIPTION OF SERVICES

4.1 Attachment 1- Academic Network Contract PWS describes the services required for this task order.

5.0 DELIVERY AND PERFORMANCE INSTRUCTIONS

5.1 Deliverables are detailed in Technical Exhibit B of the PWS for this RTOP.

6.0 INVOICING INSTRUCTIONS

6.1 Per DFARS 252.232-7006 Wide Area Work Flow Payment Instructions. See Attachment 3 for clause by full text.

7.0 SOLICITATION PROVISIONS AND TASK ORDER CLAUSES

7.1 All applicable and required provisions/clauses in the parent contract automatically flow down to all GSA 8(a) STARS3 task orders, based on their specific contract type, statement of work, competition requirements, commercial or noncommercial, and dollar value as of the date the task order solicitation is issued. Representation and Certification Provisions from the GSA 8(a) STARS3 master contract automatically flow down to all task orders.

7.2 Attachment 3 Provisions and Clauses contains FAR Optional and Agency-specific Task Order Provisions/Clauses that apply to this Task Order.

8.0 PROPOSAL PREPARATION AND SUBMISSION

8.1 Volume Organization, Format, and Guidelines:
8.1.1 Each Offeror's Proposal shall consist of four (4) volumes: Volume I – General; Volume II – Technical/Staffing and Management; Volume III – Past Performance; Volume IV – Price. The file name shall include the Offeror's name, initial submission and volume number.

8.1.2 Technical/Staffing and Management, Past Performance, and Price Proposals shall be separate volumes/documents. While the Technical Proposal must not contain any reference to price, your response must be provided in sufficient detail to evaluate the Contractor's understanding of the PWS requirements. All submissions shall be limited to letter-sized pages (8.5 x 11), font size 12. A font size of 10 is allowable for tables and graphics.

8.1.3 The length of the response is limited as identified below. Information submitted beyond these limitations will not be evaluated and could be cause for rejection of the response. Title pages, tables of contents, and glossaries are not included in the page count.

Table 2. Proposal Contents

VOLUME	QUOTATION SECTION	PAGE LIMITATIONS	FILE FORMAT
Volume I	General Information including a Table of Contents	5 Pages	PDF
Volume II	Technical / Staffing and Management	35 Pages	PDF
Volume III	Past Performance	6 Pages	PDF
Volume IV	Price	No Limitation	EXCEL

Page Format

All text shall be single spaced and in black font. Colored fonts may be used on tables, graphics, photos, company stationery and logos. Font to be used for all content other than tables and graphs: Arial. Font to be used for ONLY tables and graphics: Arial Narrow.

The Government will not evaluate pages that exceed the limitations. Should the Government choose to conduct negotiations, additional pages beyond initial limitations may be allowed

Page limit includes all appendices, charts, graphs, diagrams, tables, drawings, photographs and other pages unless specifically excluded below.

Page limit DOES NOT include covers for volumes, table of contents, glossary of acronyms and abbreviations, indices, title pages, Consent Letters, teaming arrangements, price submissions and supporting documentation, and section dividers/table if they are inserted solely to provide ease to the reader in locating parts/sections of the Proposal. Such pages will be counted if they contain any other information (i.e., diagrams, table data, etc). Pages marked “This page is intentionally left blank” will NOT be counted. Contractor Teaming Arrangements shall be submitted as a separate appendix.

A page shall be an 8 ½ X 11” sheet of paper. When both sides of a sheet display printed material, it shall be counted as two pages. Fold-outs will be counted as the appropriate number of pages based on an 8 ½” X 11” sheet of paper. Margins shall be at least 1 inch at the top and bottom and 3/4 inch on the side. The Offeror shall number each page to eliminate any confusion. In the event the Offeror creates an ambiguity in its numbering of pages, the Government may exercise its own discretion in counting pages.

8.1.4 Each volume shall include a cover page with the following information:
8.1.4.1 Volume Number and Title
8.1.4.2 Proposal
8.1.4.3 Company Name and Address
8.1.4.4 Unique Entity Identifier (EUI), Cage Code and Tax ID#

8.1.4.5 Point of Contact and Contact Information (phone number; email address)

8.2 Volume I – General:
8.2.1 Offerors shall submit company information as follows: Original signature and date; UEI Number; Acknowledgment of Task Order Amendments. Identify and explain any exceptions, deviations, and assumptions and list any Teaming Arrangements. (**Teaming Arrangement appendix shall NOT count toward the page limitations of Volume I).

8.2.2 The submission of a quotation in response to this solicitation constitutes the Offeror's acceptance of the terms and conditions of the RTOP. Any exceptions, deviations, or assumptions applied to this solicitation and its attachments must be listed in Volume I of the Offeror's Proposal. Note that exceptions, deviations or assumptions may be factored into the Government's best value analysis and may prevent the award of the Proposal.

8.2.3 Offeror's must provide a Facility Clearance (FCL) declaration statement detailing the FCL(s) held by the Prime and/or Subcontractors or Joint Venture (JV) partners. Offeror(s) must possess a FCL at a SECRET level or above at the time of offer. The Government shall not sponsor a FCL for this requirement. The FCL declaration statement must affirmatively state the proposed offeror(s) are eligible to hold this contract under a SECRET FCL. Failure to provide this statement or errors, omissions, and/or falsehoods in this statement shall be considered deficiencies. Offerors are cautioned, discovery of errors, omissions, and/or falsehoods in the FCL declaration statement after award may result in the termination for cause of this contract.

8.3 Volume II – Technical/Management Staffing Plan:
8.3.1 The Offeror shall demonstrate an understanding of the requirements of the Performance Work Statement (PWS). Provide your technical approach to satisfying the requirements of the PWS. Discuss the unique aspects of the requirement (to include specific sections and tasks of the PWS) as applicable, and your approach to satisfying these requirements. Define the risks inherent in the requirement and/or your technical approach, as well as your risk mitigation. The Technical/Management Staffing Plan volume shall be clear, concise and include sufficient detail for effective evaluation. Legibility, clarity and coherence are very important. Elaborate brochures or documentation, binding, detailed artwork, or other embellishments are unnecessary and are not desired.

8.3.2 Technical:
8.3.2.1 The proposed methodology shall, at a minimum, demonstrate the Offeror's clear understanding of the Section five (5) PWS Task Areas and the capability to perform them successfully. The Offeror shall identify their demonstrated experience, and that of any teaming partners, in performing all of Section five (5) Task Areas. The Offeror shall provide a chart summarizing the source of the expertise (prime and/or teaming partner)

for each Task Area. If there are risks in the Offeror's proposed technical approach, the Offeror shall identify the risks and provide a plan to mitigate the identified risk.

8.3.2.2 Although the Technical and Management Staffing Plan share a Volume, the Technical section shall be clearly separated from the Management Staffing Plan within the Volume.

8.3.3 Management Staffing Plan:
8.3.3.1 The Offeror's technical approach specifically addressing Management Staffing Plan shall:

8.3.3.1.1 Provide a copy of attachment 5 with column C filled in with the proposed number of FTEs by type and location. Attachment 5 shall not count toward the Volume page limitation.

8.3.3.1.2 Discuss the required qualifications of proposed labor categories. The qualifications submitted shall address at a minimum, the education, professional experience, specific experience, professional awards and other relevant activities and achievements. The qualifications proposed shall meet or exceed the requirements of the PWS. Address security clearance requirements.

8.3.3.1.3 Provide any accompanying narrative necessary to describe your approach as laid out in attachment 5. In the event that cross-training/cross-utilization of personnel is proposed, discuss your approach, to include how the qualification requirements of each of the position included in the plan will be satisfied and how you plan to backfill positions identified for cross-training and cross-utilization. Proposals which include an unrealistic utilization of or over-reliance on cross-training/cross-utilization may receive negative evaluation.

8.3.3.1.4 Address whether all personnel will be available on the start date, and the plan to phase personnel in, if necessary.

8.3.3.1.5 Address the management plan to handle personnel challenges, oversee staff and staff pools to meet performance requirements, and mitigate risks associated with personnel turnover and maintain operational readiness.

8.3.3.1.6 IAW FAR 52.222-46 The Offeror shall provide a Compensation Plan for all positions listed in Attachment 5. The Compensation Plan shall be a separate attachment to Volume II and will not count toward the page limit. In accordance with FAR 52.222-46(d), salaries that are unrealistically low or unreasonable may result in proposal rejection.

8.3.3.1.7 The contract manning detailed in PWS attachment 5 is the average of the current state of operations. It is not desired to duplicate the current attachment 5 manning for a follow-on contract.

8.3.3.1.7.1 The Government has a preference for offerors/proposals which propose a reduction in the overall number of contractor personnel/FTEs and pass that savings back to the Government. The envisioned scale of reduction is approximately 10% to 25% from the current state in PWS attachment 5. These are not hard limits, and the Government will evaluate offers which propose more reduction or less, including those which propose zero reduction or addition in personnel/FTEs.

8.3.3.1.7.2 Offerors proposing overall personnel/FTE reductions may receive evaluation preference, however proposals must also address the risks inherent in such a reduction and describe strategies, policies, etc. utilized to mitigate such risks. Proposals which include unrealistic manning staffing solutions or inadequately address the risks and risk mitigation of their proposed solution may receive negative evaluation. Only labor categories/locations with multiple positions are acceptable for reduction. Labor categories with only one position per location are not suitable for reduction and their reduction or elimination may present an unacceptable performance risk.

8.4 Volume III – Past Performance:

8.4.1 The Past Performance evaluation will be accomplished by reviewing the Offeror's recent and relevant Past Performance, focusing on performance which is relevant to the effort as it directly relates to the work being procured under this solicitation. Each Offeror may elect to submit or omit Past Performance information for evaluation. Omission of Past Performance information shall not disqualify an Offeror for award but may result in a neutral evaluation of the proposal. Past performance may be provided for the prime offeror, or partners/subcontractor(s) within a teaming arrangement or joint venture, provided an agreement executed by both parties is attached to the proposal for proof of their proposed teaming arrangement or joint venture. Offerors shall not submit more than 3 (three) past performance references; anything outside of the most recent three will NOT be reviewed. Within the limit of three (3) past performance submissions, the Government will allow subcontractor past performance attribution to the prime contractor, subject to the relevance requirements in Sec. 8.4.3.5.1 below. There is no limitation on the mix of past performance submissions between subcontractors or primes. Past performance for work performed as prime contractor or subcontractor shall be evaluated on an equal basis subject to the requirements in Sec. 8.4.3.5.1 below.

8.4.2 "Recent" is defined as work performed for six (6) months or more within the three (3) years preceding the Proposal submission deadline. "Relevant" is defined as work of similar or greater scope and magnitude to the proposed effort. Work must have been performed as a Prime or Subcontractor.

8.4.3 For each past performance reference, the Offeror shall provide the following information:

8.4.3.1 Contract Information: Provide the contract number, including specific task order or delivery order number, if applicable.

8.4.3.2 Contract Type: Identify the type of contract (e.g. FFP, Cost plus Fixed Fee, TO, etc.).

8.4.3.3 Contract Award Date: Provide the date the contract was awarded.

8.4.3.4 Period of Performance: Provide the performance period of the contract.

8.4.3.5 Prime Contractor/Subcontractor: Identify whether the Offeror (or its Teaming Partner) performed the reference as a Prime Contractor, joint venture, or a Subcontractor, indicate the amount (dollar value) and type of work performed by the Offeror (or its Teaming Partner), and the total value. If a Subcontractor, provide the name of the Prime Contractor to whom the effort was awarded.

8.4.3.5.1 Past performance submissions from offeror(s) who performed as subcontractors will receive equal consideration to those of offeror(s) who performed as prime contractors, *if* the work performed as subcontractor on that referenced contract is, in addition to "relevant" as defined in 8.4.2, comparable to the magnitude of this requirement's value (measured in dollars). Those submitting subcontractor past performance must include the overall contract price as well as the subcontracted portion value in dollars.

8.4.3.6 Contracting Activity Information: Provide the government or commercial contracting activity's Point of Contact (Procuring Contracting Officer or Administrative Contracting Officer), address and email address.

8.4.3.7 Government or Commercial Contracting Activity Technical Representative or Contracting Officer's Representative (COR) Information: Provide the technical representative or COR's name and email address.

8.4.3.8 Relevant Task Areas: A list of the current solicitation's requirements for which the Offeror believes the reference demonstrates relevancy.

8.4.3.9 (Optional) Other Relevant Documentation: Any other relevant documentation that demonstrates the Offeror's (including Teaming Partner's) past performance.

8.4.4 For each past performance reference, the Offeror shall provide a copy of all completed Contractor Performance Assessment Reports (CPARs). If CPARs is unavailable, Past Performance Questionnaires (PPQs) will be accepted using the template "Attachment 4 Past Performance Questionnaire". Teaming Partners may submit CPARs directly to the points of contact responsible for receiving Proposal submissions no later than the due date and time for receipt of Proposal. The Offeror shall identify in its Proposal whether CPARs for a past performance reference will be separately submitted by a Teaming Partner as described above.

8.4.4.1 The CPARs and PPQs for each past performance reference is excluded from the 6-page Volume III page count.

8.4.5 The Government reserves the right to consider past performance information from other sources when evaluating Offerors past performance. This information may include but is not limited to past performance information from other Government agencies or departments, past performance information from commercial sources or clients, past performance information from other Contractors or Subcontractors, and internal Government databases.

8.5 Volume IV- Price:

8.5.1 The Pricing Proposal shall be in Microsoft Excel and shall be compatible with Microsoft Office 2013. Microsoft Excel spreadsheets shall not be read only or password protected. All formulas, lookup tables, and links shall be intact, and no links shall exist to files not included with the submission. Spreadsheets shall not contain hidden worksheets. PDF or flat files will not be considered adequate. The Offeror shall perform a virus check prior to Proposal submittal.

8.5.2 The Offeror shall complete and submit Attachment 2, Contract Line Items by Contract Line-Item Number (CLIN). The Offeror shall not enter prices on CLINs associated with Travel and shall instead rely upon the Not-to-Exceed amounts provided by the Government. It shall be the responsibility of the Offeror to ensure this, and all other Proposal attachments are submitted free of errors/omissions.

8.5.3 The Offeror shall complete and submit Attachment 5, Estimate Number of Manpower per Location Fill-In. The Offeror shall provide in the additional tabs all fully burdened rates per LCAT per option year.

8.5.4 Offerors are required to identify all labor categories proposed for which the proposed rate exceeds the rates stated in the base GSA contract. Offerors must provide a justification for the rate premium.

9.0 EVALUATION FACTORS AND BASIS OF AWARD

9.1 The Government intends to award a single firm fixed price task order to the Offeror who provides the Government with the best value based on the evaluation criteria identified within the RTOP, using procedures in FAR subpart 16.5. The procedures at FAR 15.3, Source Selection do not apply to this acquisition.

9.2 The Government intends to evaluate proposals and award a contract without discussions with offerors but reserves the right to seek clarification or initiate discussions at the contracting officer’s discretion.

9.3 The Government shall first apply gate criteria for price (Volume IV) prior to evaluation of non-price quality factors. Only the ten proposals which have the lowest

total evaluated price shall be further evaluated in non-price quality factors and considered for award.

9.4 The total evaluated price will be calculated by adding the base period plus each option year. An additional 6-month period (IAW 52.217-8) will be added to the total. This 6-month period shall be calculated by multiplying the final option year by 0.5 (or 50%). The total evaluated price shall equal Base + 4 Option Years + Additional 6 Month (52.217-8) period.

9.4.1 It is not anticipated that a price realism analysis will be necessary, however the Contracting Officer may elect to conduct price realism analysis if it is determined proposed pricing is unreasonably low and/or unbalanced. The method of analysis shall come from FAR 15.404.

Table 3. Technical Rating Method

Adjectival rating	**Description**
Strength	Proposal contains components which will either meet the requirements by showing merit, or exceed contract specifications and is advantageous to the Government, or the proposal demonstrates an exceptional approach and understanding of the requirement.
Weakness	Proposal contains a flaw that may risk successful contract performance but does not completely demonstrate an inability to perform, or the proposal does not demonstrate an adequate approach and understanding of the requirement.
Deficiency	Proposal fails to meet the requirements of solicitation or adequately address the solicitation and/or PWS requirements. -OR- A single weakness of such significance that risk of unsuccessful performance is unacceptable and/or demonstrates a lack of adequate understanding/approach to satisfy the contract requirements. -OR- A combination of multiple weaknesses which when combined increase the risk of unsuccessful performance to unacceptable levels and/or demonstrate a lack of adequate understanding/approach to satisfy the contract requirements.

9.5 The Government will employ a Best Value Trade-Off evaluation method for this requirement. As a basis for award, trade-offs between price and non-price quality factors are permitted. Therefore, the Government reserves the right to award to an Offeror quoting other than the lowest proposed price. If a proposal is selected for award based upon a trade-off with non-price quality factors, the Government shall incorporate those elements of the contractor's proposal which justified the awarded task order contract.

9.6 Proposals shall be evaluated based upon Technical Capability, Staffing and Management Plan, Past Performance and Price. No ratings shall be assigned to each factor of evaluation; however, strengths, weaknesses and deficiencies shall be

assessed and documented for Technical Capability, Staffing Management Plan, and Past Performance. Any proposal containing one or more deficiencies shall be ineligible for award.

9.7 Management Staffing Plan is more important than Technical Capability and Technical Capability is more important than Past Performance. All non-price quality factors, Management Staffing Plan and Technical Capability and Past Performance, when combined, are more important than Price. As quality factors converge toward equality in evaluation, price becomes increasingly important.

9.8 The Government shall select for award the proposal which provides the overall best value to the Government, considering all non-price quality factors and price.

10. LIST OF ATTACHMENTS

1. Academic Network Contract PWS
2. Contract Line Item Numbers Academic Network
3. Provisions and Clauses
4. Past Performance Questionnaire Template
5. Estimate Number of Manpower per Location Fill-In
6. Joint Venture Facility Clearance Memorandum